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NAVIGATING MONETARY POLICY IN THE WAKE OF SHIFTING MARKETS

The **College FED Challenge** is a yearly competition for undergraduate students hosted by the Federal Reserve.

Our team analyzes current economic conditions using a large number of indicators describing financial, labor, housing, and goods markets.

We pull data from FRED® and other sources of economic data in order to generate graphs to depict short-run and long-run trends in our economy.

Using team-based discussion, we evaluate which economic trends and indicators are the most relevant, examining our economy through micro- and macroeconomic lenses.

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30
31 ## Pull FRED Data Function
32 fetch_fred_data <- function(series_id, start_date, end_date = Sys.Date()) {
33   if (as.Date(start_date) < as.Date(start_date)) {
34     stop("end_date must be after start_date")
35   }
36   fredr(
37     series_id = series_id,
38     observation_start = start_date,
39     observation_end = as.Date(end_date)
40   )
41 }
42
43 ## Create Graph for Plots (Only one Line)
44 create_line_plot <- function(data, y_label, g_name) {
45   p <- ggplot(data, aes(x = date, y = value)) +
46     geom_line(linewidth = 1, color = "blue") +
47     labs(x = "Year", y = y_label) +
48     theme_bw() +
49     theme(
50       panel.grid = element_blank(),
51       axis.title = element_text(size = 20, face = "bold"),
52       axis.text = element_text(size = 15, color = "black"),
53       axis.ticks = element_line(color = "black"),
54       panel.border = element_blank(),
55       axis.line = element_line(color = "black", size = 0.5)
56     )
57   scale_x_date(
58     date.breaks = "24 months",
59     date_labels = "%b %y"
60   )
61   scale_y_continuous(
62     limits = c(12, max(inv_div_gdp_r$value, na.rm = TRUE)),
63     breaks = seq(0, max(inv_div_gdp_r$value, na.rm = TRUE), by = 2) # Adjust

```

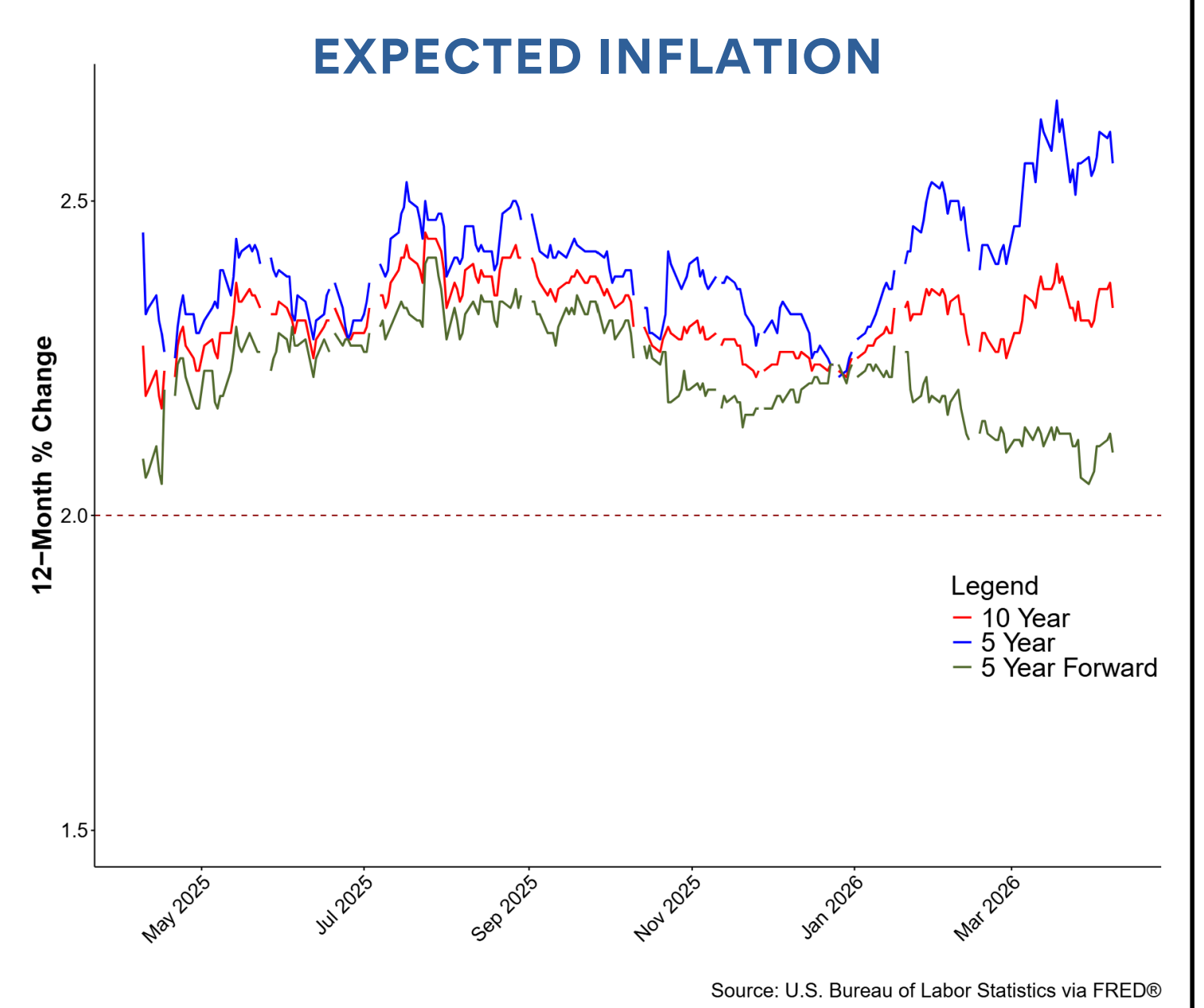
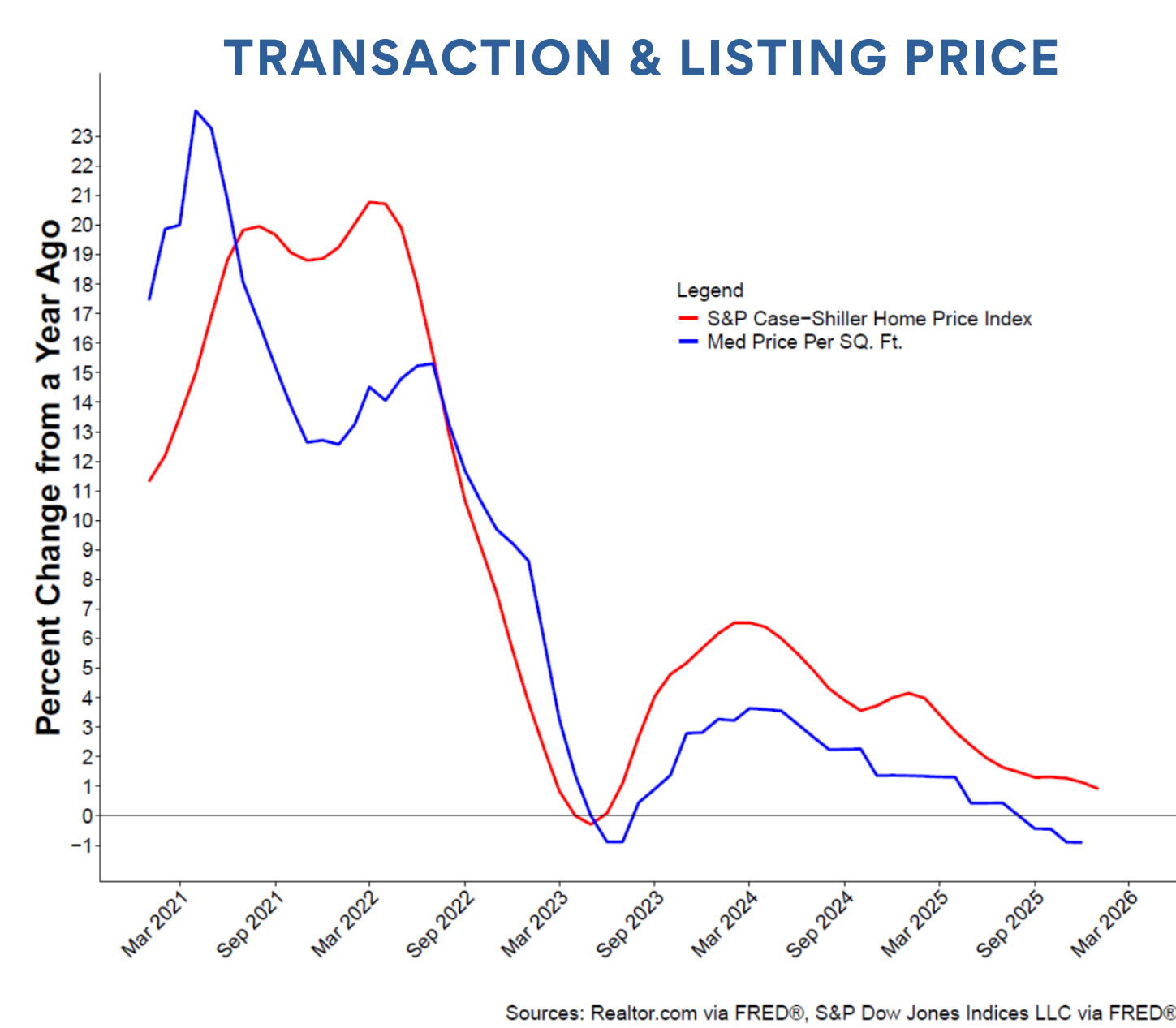
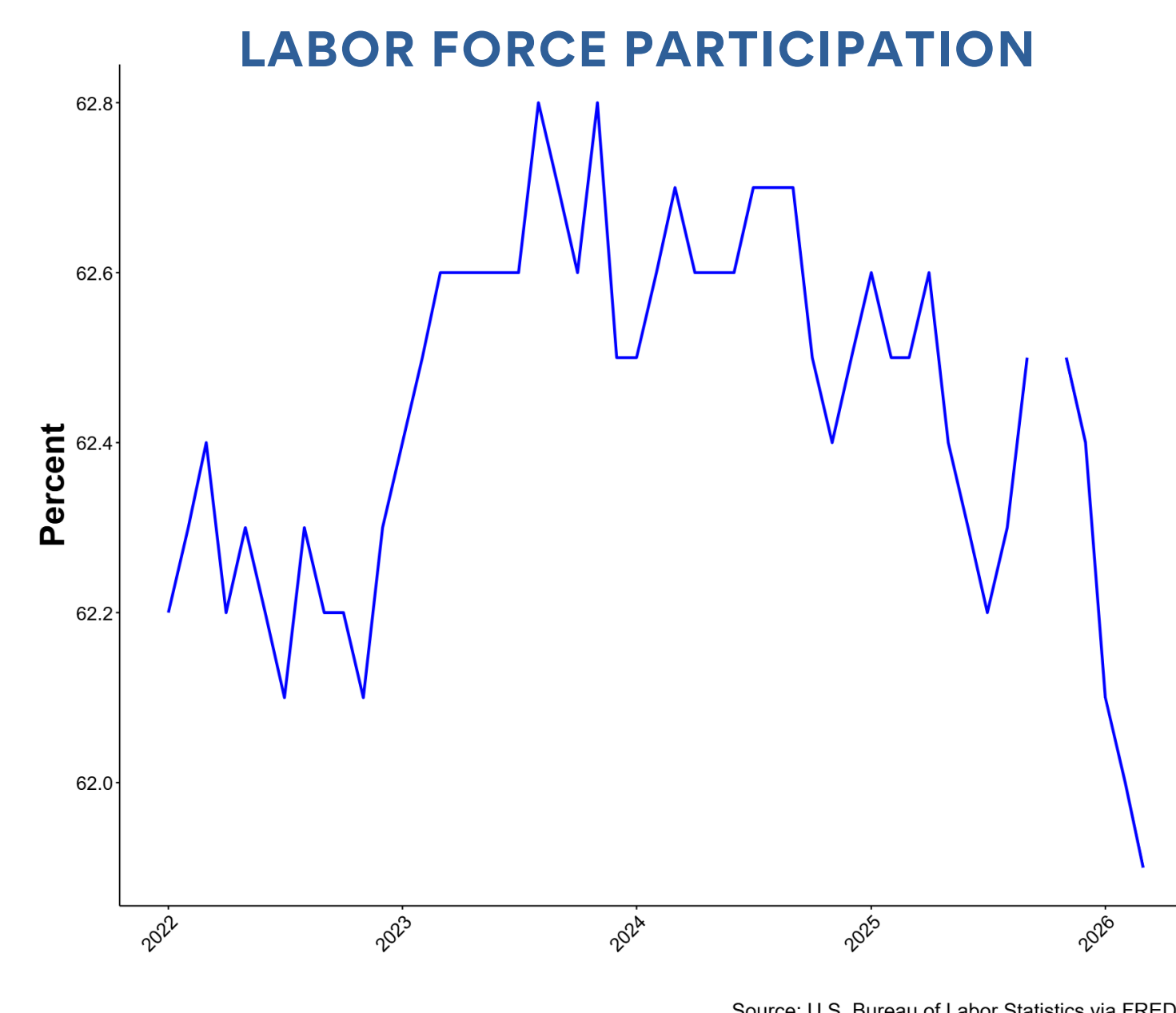
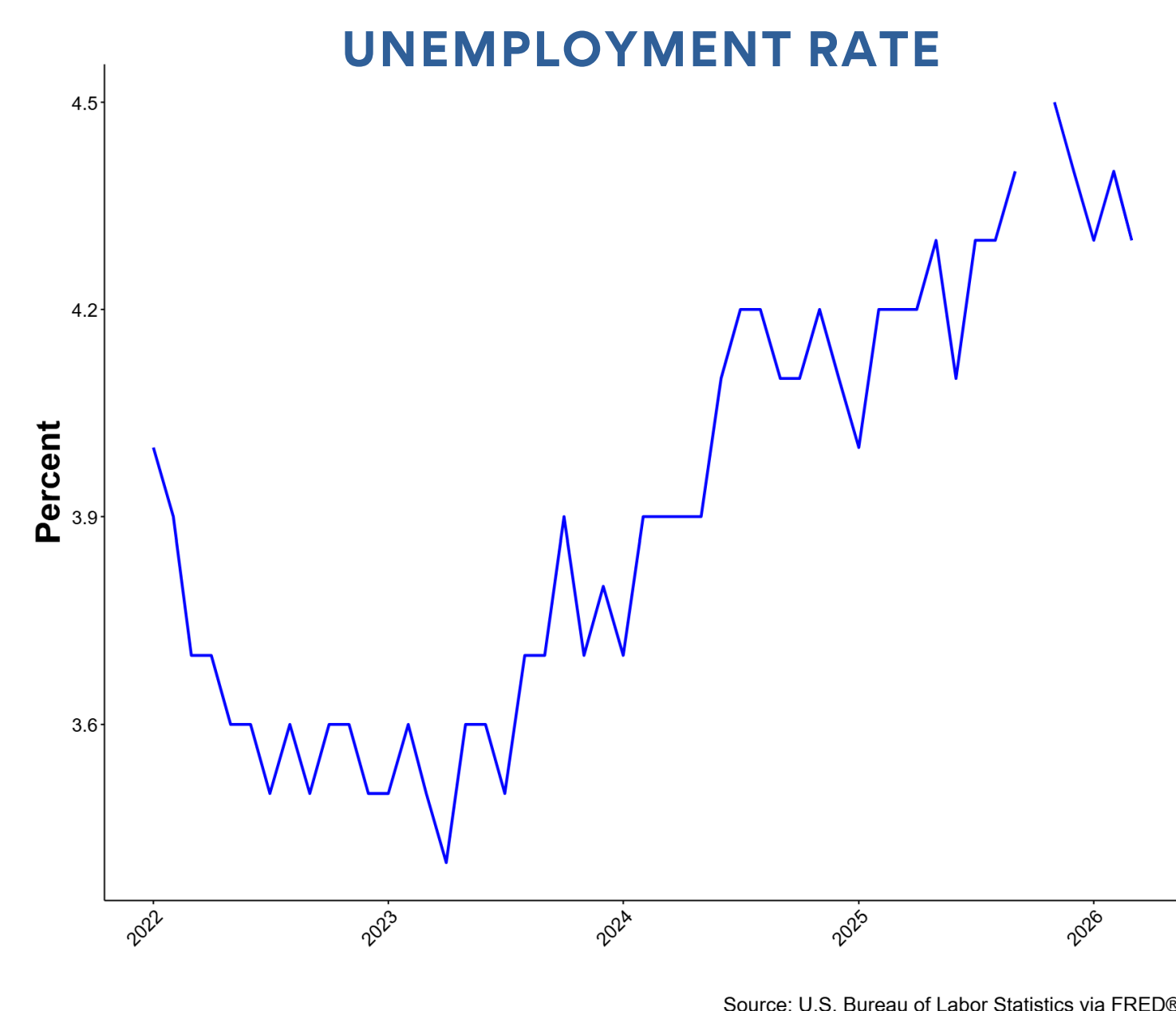
INFLATION

Legend

- CPI
- Core CPI

Date	CPI	Core CPI
Feb 2022	7.5	6.0
Jun 2022	8.5	6.5
Oct 2022	8.0	6.0
Feb 2023	6.5	5.5
Jun 2023	3.0	5.0
Oct 2023	3.5	4.0
Feb 2024	3.0	3.5
Jun 2024	3.0	3.0
Oct 2024	2.5	2.5
Feb 2025	2.5	2.5
Jun 2025	2.5	2.5
Oct 2025	2.5	2.5
Feb 2026	3.0	2.5

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics via FRED®

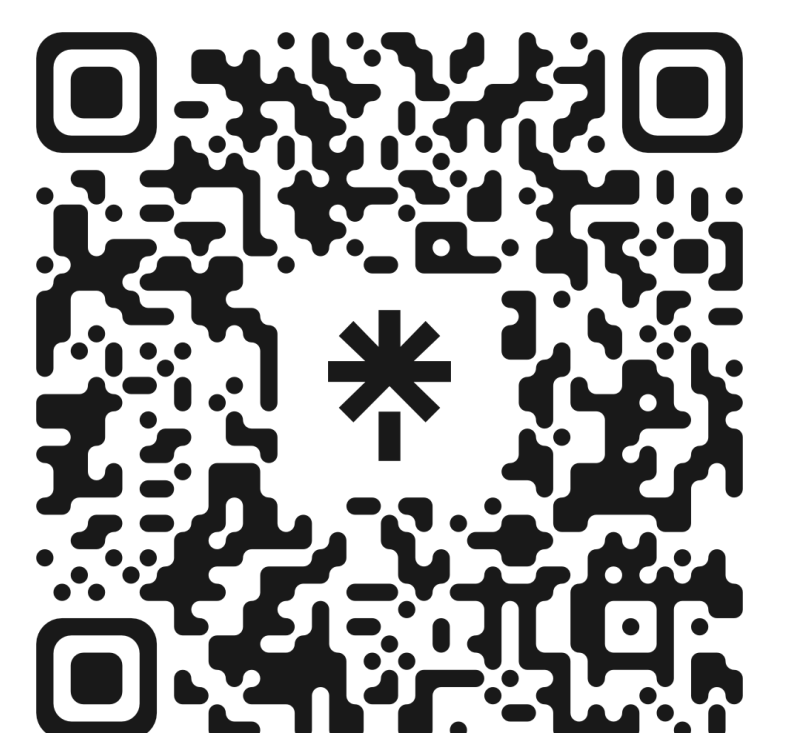


- Labor market cooling, with unemployment stable near the natural rate despite slowing job growth
- Inflation easing but still elevated due to services and recent supply-side shocks
- Growth slowing as financial conditions tighten and interest rates weigh on housing and overall demand

- Maintain the current policy rate to balance persistent inflation risks with slowing growth
- Avoid premature rate cuts or additional hikes, as both pose risks to stability and long-term growth
- Continue a data-dependent, “wait-and-see” approach as new information emerges

All undergrads are welcome to be a part of our team!

Contact Dr. Rafael Ribas at RafaelRibas@boisestate.edu, or scan the QR code to connect with us on our socials.



OTHER MEMBERS: SERENA ALLEN, CHANDLER CURTIS, WILLIAM-JAMES GUERRERO, DEA JAZVIN, HENA LEE, ADAM MATRAI, MOLLY SLEEMAN